

TEST 3, WRITING TASK 2

This model has been prepared by an examiner as an example of a very good answer.

The move from rural areas to urban areas seems inevitable as people relocate in pursuit of better work and study opportunities, along with a more highly developed infrastructure. This essay will argue that while there are advantages for individuals, as well as for rural and urban societies, on the whole it is a negative development.

When they move from the countryside to the city, individuals benefit from more advanced transport, health services and entertainment. Cities see a diverse range of people coming in from different parts of the country, leading to vibrant cultural mix. When people move to the city for training and education, this brings many positives to their lives in terms of opportunities for work, wealth and fulfilment. However, with the rise in working remotely, the opportunities available to those in rural areas are not as limited as they were before as it is possible for many people to study or work there without having to relocate.

People moving to the city can have a negative effect on rural areas as it means that they are not there to support the local economy or community. In time, it becomes a vicious circle as the more people leave a rural community, the less that community has to offer, so the more people leave. For many individuals, the move can be difficult; city life can be expensive, stressful and competitive. In cities, an influx of newcomers can lead to overcrowding and pressure on public services like transport and hospitals.

Overall it seems that while it is understandable that people want to move to cities from rural areas, it tends to bring more challenges than benefits.

Here are comments from another examiner:

This is a good response to the task and the position is clear from the first paragraph: the candidate thinks the general move of the population to the cities is a negative development. Ideas are presented within two main paragraphs: one lists the benefits for people of facilities in cities [*transport | health services and entertainment | cultural mix | training and education | work*] and the other describes the [*negative effect on rural areas*].

The organisation of ideas into two main paragraphs, one with the benefits of city life and one with the negative impacts, is not entirely logical. For example, in the second paragraph, the comment on remote working [*it is possible for many people to study or work there without having to relocate*] does not fit into the central topic of the benefits of moving to the city. Then, the third paragraph covers both the negatives for the rural area and the negatives of city life for those who make the move. This would be better separated into two paragraphs.

There is a good range of vocabulary with some flexibility and precision [*relocate in pursuit of | vibrant cultural mix | fulfilment | working remotely | vicious circle | influx | overcrowding*], and the range of grammar is also wide and generally accurate. Grammatical structures include comparatives [*not as limited as | the more ... the less ... the more | more challenges than*] within multi-clause sentences, and future and present time structures [*This essay will argue | tends to bring*]. However, there is some repetition of structures [*can*].

To improve the overall score, the grouping of ideas within the paragraphs could be clearer and there could be less repetition of similar grammatical structures.